

Personal Statement

Quinn Rivera • Applicant APP_008

Application ID	APP_008
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Personal Essay

The first afternoon I joined environmental club volunteer, I expected to complete a task and go home. Instead, I found a room full of people with different ideas about what success should look like. I began by listening, taking notes, and turning a vague goal into a short list of responsibilities. That small act of organization made it easier for everyone to contribute.

Over time, the work became less about checking boxes and more about learning how evidence changes a decision. When our first plan stalled, I asked teammates what information we were missing. We revised the schedule, divided the work according to each person's strengths, and created a simple way to track progress. The result was not perfect, but it was shared, measurable, and better than what any one of us had proposed alone.

That experience shaped my interest in Biochemistry. I am drawn to questions that require both careful analysis and an understanding of the people affected by an answer. In class, I have tried to connect concepts across subjects instead of treating each assignment as isolated. Outside class, I have learned that patient explanation can matter as much as having the correct solution.

College will bring problems whose boundaries are not already defined. I want to be the person who can clarify the question, invite useful perspectives, and keep working when the first approach fails. I will bring curiosity, steady preparation, and a willingness to revise my assumptions. Most of all, I will bring the habit of turning uncertainty into a reason to ask better questions.

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